

Semiconductor Peer Comparison

Date: June 6, 2026 | Coverage: QCOM, AMD, NVDA, INTC, AVGO | Source: SEC EDGAR XBRL filings (10-K/10-Q)

Executive view

The dominant theme across this five-company peer group is structural divergence — in business model, AI exposure, and capital intensity. **Nvidia has the strongest operating profile:** 75% gross margins, 65% operating margins, and \$97B in trailing FCF on \$216B of revenue. **Intel's valuation is the hardest to justify on current fundamentals** — 11.2x EV/TTM Revenue despite negative operating income, negative FCF, and three years of restructuring; the market is pricing in the foundry turnaround and 18A node. **Broadcom is the most structurally distinct**, operating a hybrid semiconductor-plus-software model (58/42 split) with no peer parallel. Cross-peer comparison without adjusting for these differences is misleading.

Operating comparison

Revenue growth. Nvidia led at +65% (\$130.5B to \$215.9B), followed by AMD +34% (\$25.8B to \$34.6B), Broadcom +24% (\$51.6B to \$63.9B, partly VMware transition), Qualcomm +14% (\$39.0B to \$44.3B), and Intel roughly flat at \$52.9B.

Margins. Latest-quarter gross margins: Nvidia 75%, Broadcom 68% (boosted by software subscriptions), Qualcomm 55% (inflated by 72%-margin QTL licensing), AMD 54%, Intel 36%. Intel's Foundry segment posted a \$10.3B operating loss; the Products division alone earned 26% operating margin.

FCF generation. Nvidia \$97B TTM, Broadcom \$26.9B, Qualcomm \$12.8B, AMD \$6.7B (growing but modest relative to market cap), Intel -\$4.9B (structurally negative from \$11.2B net CapEx).

R&D intensity. Intel 24%, AMD 23%, Qualcomm 21%, Broadcom 17% (low ratio reflects software base), Nvidia 8% (lowest ratio but highest absolute spend at \$18.5B).

Balance sheet. Nvidia and AMD are net-cash positive (~\$2B each). Qualcomm carries \$9.3B net debt. Broadcom (\$50.9B) and Intel (\$31.9B) are heavily leveraged — Broadcom from VMware, Intel from its fab buildout with \$34.5B in construction in progress.

Valuation comparison

Metric	QCOM	AMD	NVDA	INTC	AVGO
EV/TTM Revenue	6.0x	24.6x	24.5x	11.2x	31.8x
P/TTM FCF	19.9x	126.7x	54.7x	N/A	73.7x
FCF Yield	5.0%	0.8%	1.8%	-0.9%	1.4%

Broadcom's 31.8x prices in AI networking growth and recurring software revenue. AMD and Nvidia trade at nearly identical revenue multiples (~24.5x) despite Nvidia's far superior margins — AMD's multiple assumes substantial

margin expansion. Qualcomm at 6.0x is cheapest on every metric, reflecting Apple insourcing risk and limited data-center AI exposure. Intel's multiple on negative FCF is a foundry bet.

P/E and EV/EBITDA are excluded. Q4 diluted EPS is missing for all five companies (cannot be derived from YTD XBRL data) and EBITDA requires depreciation/amortization tags not yet in the pipeline.

Key company-specific observations

Qualcomm. QTL licensing (~13% of revenue, 72% margin) has no peer equivalent. Three named customers (Apple, Samsung, Xiaomi) each exceed 10% of revenue; Apple modem insourcing risk is explicitly disclosed. AI exposure is on-device only.

AMD. Data Center is 48% of revenue, growing 32% YoY. Margin improving to 50% despite \$440M MI308 export-control charges. R&D growth (+25% to \$8.1B) prioritized over buybacks (\$1.3B).

Nvidia. Scale leader (\$216B revenue, \$97B FCF), but gross margin declined on the Blackwell transition and a \$4.5B H20 export-control charge. China revenue fell 21% to \$19.7B. One customer at 13%.

Intel. Fundamental restructuring: FY2025 operating loss \$2.2B, FY2024 -\$11.7B. Foundry lost \$10.3B with only \$307M external revenue. Dividends eliminated; \$7B raised through dilutive equity issuances (SoftBank, Nvidia); \$8B in CHIPS Act funding with 275M shares plus warrants issued to the government.

Broadcom. Software segment (\$27B, 42% of revenue) has no peer parallel. AI semi revenue \$10.8B in Q2 FY2026 (+143% YoY) from custom XPUs and networking. Debt of \$67.1B is highest in the group.

Risks and catalysts

- **AI demand durability.** Nvidia (90% of revenue) and Broadcom (~49% of Q2 revenue) most exposed to hyperscaler CapEx cycles. Intel's Gaudi accelerator has inventory write-downs suggesting weak traction.
- **Export restrictions.** Already triggered \$4.5B (Nvidia), \$800M (AMD) in charges; further restrictions would compress the AI accelerator TAM.
- **Product transitions.** Blackwell ramp (Nvidia margin pressure), 18A/14A node risk (Intel), Apple modem insourcing (Qualcomm).
- **Customer concentration.** Intel top 3 = 43%, Broadcom top 5 = 40%, Qualcomm three customers each >10%.
- **Capital intensity.** Intel's \$11—23B/year CapEx produces structurally negative FCF. Broadcom's \$67B debt requires sustained cash generation.
- **Acquisition integration.** Broadcom FY2024 was a 53-week VMware transition year; FY2023-to-FY2024 comparisons are unreliable.

Data limitations

- **Fiscal year-ends differ:** Qualcomm (Sep), Intel/AMD (Dec), Nvidia (Jan), Broadcom (Nov). Calendar-quarter alignment is not yet implemented.
- **Q4 diluted EPS missing** for all five companies (15 instances); requires earnings press releases.
- **Nvidia FY2024 CapEx Q1—Q3** sourced from 8-K press releases, not XBRL; pending manual confirmation.
- **Intel cash tag** includes ~\$447M restricted cash (~3% overstatement vs peers).
- **Intel non-recurring charges:** FY2024 included \$7.0B restructuring, \$3.1B goodwill impairments, \$9.9B deferred tax allowance. GAAP margins are not comparable to peers without non-GAAP adjustment.
- **Intel CapEx** (\$11—23B/year IDM) is structurally incomparable to fabless peers (\$0.5—6B).
- **Broadcom debt** uses gross principal (\$67.1B), ~\$2B / ~3% above carrying value used by other peers.
- **Broadcom FY2024:** 53 weeks, VMware full-year consolidation vs ~5 weeks in FY2023. Revenue +44% was primarily acquisition-driven.

AI-assisted workflow

Automated by Claude: SEC EDGAR data download, XBRL quarterly extraction, Q4 derivation (FY minus 9-month YTD), ratio calculation, TTM aggregation, peer consolidation, and qualitative-claim sourcing with direct quotes and SEC filing URLs.

Required human judgment: XBRL tag selection (companies use different tags for equivalent concepts), Nvidia CapEx 8-K sourcing confirmation, review of all 40 qualitative claims, valuation input validation, and interpretation of comparability limitations.

Value labeling: every metric carries an `extraction\_method`: `reported\_standalone`, `derived\_ytd\_difference`, `fiscal\_year\_end\_balance`, `reported\_earnings\_release`, or `missing\_requires\_review`. Derived values are shaded yellow in the workbook; missing values pink; manual-review items amber.

Validation: Qualcomm serves as an immutable regression benchmark (132 financials, 120 metrics rows). After each company addition or refactor, automated checks confirmed identical Qualcomm output. Cross-validation includes FY total reconciliation, gross-profit tag comparison, and debt-component verification.

This memo does not constitute investment advice. All data sourced from public SEC filings. Qualitative claims are labeled factual or interpretive and have been human-reviewed. No buy or sell recommendation is made.